

norities. Over the years, this status has been acquired by the Hindi-speaking community. Hindi leaders in Mumbai are bent upon destabilising the sub-nation called Maharashtra. India's think tank should first accept the ground reality of sub-nationalism and then try to find solutions for it.

Colour of Terror

The alleged involvement of some Hindu organisations in the conspiracy of blasts at Malegaon has stunned the entire nation ("The New Terror Threat", November 10). Saffron is the colour of sacrifice and salvation, but Pragya Singh Thakur's alleged association in the Malegaon blasts has tainted its sanctity and questioned its immaculacy. Earlier, we focused on exported terrorism from across the border. With her arrest, one thing is sure: terror is often homegrown and deadly. Stringent action against the perpetrators of terror in the name of religion and community will surely act as a deterrent.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Sadhvi Pragya's arrest in the Malegaon blasts will give enough fuel for other religions to belittle, berate and lampoon Hinduism. In one stroke, the community has lost the right to criticise and condemn other radical and fundamentalist groups operating

in the country. The terrorists are at large and they are here among us.

K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN,
Bangalore

Charity Clamp

The Government's stand on monitoring the flow of foreign funds in the form of donations coming into the country ("Turning Off The Tap", November 3) is praiseworthy. Apart from Rs 7,000 crore (and more) coming in from outside, we

Endless Conflict

The civil war between the Sri Lankan Government and Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) since 1983 has claimed the lives of many Tamils ("Cornering Prabhakaran", November 10). Over the years, Tamils have been at the receiving end. If this wasn't enough, making Sinhalese the official language was yet another move to make Tamils feel like lesser citizens. The



If only other sportspersons could emulate Viswanathan Anand's humility, consistency, dedication and power-packed performance, Indian sports would be a power to reckon with.

AMITABH THAKUR, *Lucknow*

do have contributions from within the country as well which are being used to fund illegal activities in the name of charity. This will help keep track of donations and weed out organisations which use funds for fuelling terror and violence in the country in the name of charity.

AJITH, *on e-mail*

Sinhalese government has disregarded all the agreements to bring peace in the troubled paradise. Your report throws a fair deal of light on the Tamil problem in the strife-torn island nation thereby compelling the Centre and the state to take up the matter with the Sri Lankan Government.

V.S. SANKARAN, *on e-mail*

Simple Folk

"So what if my son is a chief minister. I'm carrying on my farming. I make enough to eat, even though I cannot give haircuts anymore," said the 85-year-old weather-beaten patriarch. "What do I need his money for?" In a land of affluent politicians, and their even richer relatives, Gokul Thakur, wrapped in an ancient coarse cotton blanket, sporting a check-cloth turban and wearing a dirty cotton dhoti, and worn out chappals, is an oddity. No one would think that he is the father of Karpoori Thakur, the chief minister of Bihar. Sitting on a wooden bench near the family's freshly harvested fields, Gokul Thakur said about his son: "He is not bothered whether we eat or not. He does not send money home. All that I want is that he should do his job properly and shouldn't make money on the side. What God gives us is enough for me."

Arul B. Louis



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